Samuel Okafor

Staff Software Engineer | Developer Platform · Kubernetes · Terraform · AWS

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SUMMARY

Staff engineer setting technical direction for an internal developer platform used by 38 product teams (~260 engineers). 13+ years across platform, reliability, and payments. Led a 140-service move to Kubernetes that cut infrastructure cost 31% (~$2.4M a year).

SELECTED IMPACT

- Moved 140 services from self-managed VMs to Kubernetes on AWS EKS over 5 quarters; infrastructure cost down 31% (~$2.4M a year).
- Raised deployment frequency from roughly weekly per service to ~40 deploys a day across the organization.
- Wrote the service ownership and on-call RFC adopted org-wide in 2023; sev-1 incidents fell from 14 in 2023 to 5 in 2024 alongside other reliability work.
- Mentored 6 engineers, 3 of whom were promoted to senior.

EXPERIENCE

Staff Software Engineer, Developer Platform · Tidewater Commerce · Toronto, ON (remote) *Mar 2022 – Present*

- Own technical direction for the internal developer platform that 38 product teams (~260 engineers) build on.
- Led the migration of 140 services from self-managed VMs to Kubernetes (AWS EKS) over 5 quarters: wrote the migration RFC, ran a weekly migration guild, and completed the first 10 migrations myself as templates for other teams. Infrastructure cost fell 31% (~$2.4M a year, finance's figure).
- Built golden-path service templates with Terraform modules, GitHub Actions, and Argo CD, cutting new-service setup from ~2 weeks to 1 day.
- Wrote the service ownership and on-call RFC adopted org-wide in 2023; sev-1 incidents fell from 14 in 2023 to 5 in 2024 alongside other reliability work.
- Chair the architecture review, reviewing ~50 design docs a year.
- Rolled out Prometheus and Grafana monitoring for platform services.
- Write Go and Python platform tooling, including a CLI and Kubernetes operators.
- Mentored 6 engineers, 3 of whom were promoted to senior.

Senior Software Engineer · Tidewater Commerce · Toronto, ON *Feb 2020 – Feb 2022*

- Built the company's first shared CI/CD on GitHub Actions and Argo CD, adopted by 25 teams; median build time dropped from 35 to 12 minutes.
- Led checkout reliability work that raised availability from 99.5% to 99.95%.

Career Break — Family Caregiving *Jun 2019 – Jan 2020*

Senior Software Engineer · Northpoint Bank *Jun 2016 – May 2019*

- Led a team of 4 engineers building a real-time fraud scoring service in Java and Spring Boot, handling 3,000 transactions per second; card fraud losses fell 22% in the first year after launch (risk team report).

Software Engineer · Northpoint Bank *Jul 2014 – May 2016*

- Built internal payments APIs in Java.

Software Developer · Pixelgrove Studios *Jul 2012 – Jun 2014*

- Built PHP and JavaScript websites for agency clients.

SKILLS

Platform: Kubernetes (AWS EKS), Terraform, Argo CD, GitHub Actions, Amazon Web Services (AWS)

Languages: Go, Python, Java

Observability: Prometheus, Grafana
Data: PostgreSQL
Practices: RFCs and architecture review, multi-team migrations, on-call and incident management, mentoring

TALKS

Paved Roads at 260 Engineers · Toronto Platform Engineering Meetup *2024*

EDUCATION

B.A.Sc. Computer Engineering · Westmount University *2012*